

Refund policy

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1. Introduction

Purpose and scope

This Refund Policy is an integral part of the “Terms and Conditions” and shall be read and interpreted in conjunction with it.

The purpose of this refund policy is to provide clear guidelines and procedures for customers and merchants on the QFREEMART platform regarding refunds for products sold on the platform. The policy aims to ensure that customers are able to receive refunds for eligible products in a fair and timely manner, while also protecting the interests of merchants.

QFREEMART operates as a neutral marketplace platform that connects customers with independent vendors. All products and services listed on the platform are offered directly by vendors. Vendors are solely responsible for approving, processing, and issuing refunds, replacements, or exchanges relating to their products or services unless otherwise stated by the vendor.

QFREEMART does not collect, hold, process, or distribute payments relating to product or service purchases between customers and vendors. Accordingly, QFREEMART does not process, track, or issue refunds for such transactions. All refund requests, approvals, and payments are handled directly between the customer and the vendor according to the vendor's policies and applicable laws.

In limited circumstances, QFREEMART may, at its sole discretion, refund platform-related fees such as subscription charges, platform commissions, or service fees that were paid directly to QFREEMART. Such refunds are evaluated on a case-by-case basis after reviewing the circumstances and are not guaranteed.

This refund policy applies to all merchants and customers on the QFREEMART platform. It covers all items sold on the platform, including perishable items, fresh fruits, and non-perishable items. The policy outlines the conditions under which refunds are granted, the required documentation for refund requests, and the timeframe for processing and issuing refunds. By using the QFREEMART platform, all merchants and customers agree to comply with this refund policy.

2. Definitions

“Perishable Items” refer to products that have a limited shelf life and are likely to spoil or become unfit for consumption if not stored or handled properly. Examples of perishable items include dairy products, meat, seafood, and fresh produce.

“Non-perishable items” refer to products that have a longer shelf life and are less likely to spoil or become unfit for consumption. Examples of non-perishable items include canned goods, packaged snacks, and household items.

“Fresh fruits” refer to fruits that are not canned, dried, or frozen and are intended for immediate consumption. Examples of fresh fruits include apples, bananas, and oranges.

“Other products” refer to any items sold on the QFREEMART platform that do not fall under the categories of perishable or non-perishable items or fresh fruits.

“Vendor” (also referred to as Merchant or Seller) is an individual or business entity that sells products or services on the QFREEMART platform.

“Customer” is an individual who purchases products from merchants on the QFREEMART platform.

“Product” also called as **“Items”** refers to any goods or service offered for sale on the Marketplace

“Right to return” means that customers can send back a product they bought from an online store within a certain time period. This is so they can get their money back or exchange the product if it's not what they expected or is faulty. The online store's refund policy will explain the specific conditions for returns. Customers need to show proof of purchase and a valid reason for the return, and the customer will pay for the shipping unless otherwise stated in the refund policy. The right to return, replace, or exchange items depends on the nature of the product, vendor policies, and applicable consumer protection laws. Certain categories of goods may not be eligible for return once delivered unless defective, damaged, or incorrectly supplied. The right to return is important because it helps customers make good choices and avoid being stuck with products they don't want or can't use.

“Right to replace” an item means that customers can ask for a new product to replace the one they bought from an online store within a certain time period, if the original item is defective or damaged.

“Right to exchange” an item means that customers can ask for a different product to replace the one they bought from an online store within a certain time period. This is so they can get a product that better suits their needs or preferences. The online store's refund policy will explain the specific conditions for exchanges. Customers need to show proof of purchase and a valid reason for the exchange, and the customer will pay for the shipping unless otherwise stated in the refund policy. Consumer protection laws protect the right to exchange an item, so customers can feel safe to use it.

“Right to refuse” means that customers have the legal right to decline or reject a product or service offered by an online store. This is so they can make their own choices and not be forced to buy something they don't want or need. The online store's terms and conditions will explain the specific conditions for refusing a product or service. Customers can refuse a product or service for any reason, as long as it does not violate any laws or regulations. Consumer protection laws protect the right to refuse, so customers can feel safe to use it.

3. General Guidelines

3.1 Order Acceptance

Merchants on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for ensuring that all orders are accurately fulfilled and shipped to customers. Customers have the right to cancel an order before it is accepted, and merchants have the right to cancel an order if the product is out of stock or unavailable.

3.2 Timeframe for Requesting a Refund

Customers must request a refund within the timeframe specified by the vendor for each product listing. Unless otherwise specified by the vendor, refund requests should generally be raised within 48 hours of delivery for perishable products and within 7 days of delivery for non-perishable items.

3.3 Conditions Under Which Refunds are Granted

Refunds will only be granted for eligible products that meet the conditions outlined in the refund policy. These conditions may include damaged, spoiled, or incorrect items, or items that do not meet the product description. Refunds will not be granted for products that have been used or consumed, or for products that have been damaged due to customer negligence.

3.4 Refund Methods

Refunds are issued solely by the Vendor who received the payment from the customer. The method and timing of refunds will depend on the payment arrangement between the customer and the vendor and the vendor's refund policies. QFREEMART does not process refund transactions and does not guarantee the timing or method of refunds.

3.5 Returns

In some cases, customers may be required to return the product in order to receive a refund. The return process will be clearly outlined in the refund policy and may include instructions for packaging and shipping the product back to the merchant. Customers are responsible for the cost of return shipping unless otherwise stated in the refund policy.

3.6 Exchange or Replacement of items

The availability of items ordered is subject to stock availability at the respective stores. To successfully complete an order, the seller reserves the right to amend the order in whole or in part, at any time and without any liability or compensation. The seller also reserves the right to remove any item that is out of stock, damaged, spoiled, or unavailable for any other reason. It is important to note that the seller will communicate any changes to the order to the customer. The customer can contact the seller directly if they have any questions or concerns about the order. The seller will make every effort to ensure that the customer is satisfied with their purchase and will work with the customer to resolve any issues that may arise.

Merchant will make every effort to ensure that all items listed on the Site as "available" are in fact available and in stock. However, if any product that a customer orders is out of stock or unavailable for any other reason, including being damaged or spoiled, Merchant may send a push notification to the customer. This will enable the customer to select a replacement item ("Replacements"), which they may choose to accept or reject. It is important to note that the customer will not incur any liability if they reject the Replacements. We will work with the customer to ensure that they are satisfied with their purchase and will make every effort to resolve any issues that may arise.

Merchant will make every effort to ensure that the price of the Replacement(s) is the same as the item you originally ordered. If the replacement item has a higher price than the original item, the customer must confirm acceptance of the price difference before the replacement is processed. It is important to note that we use our best efforts to ensure that the price of the Replacement(s) is the same as the item you originally ordered. However, in some cases, the price of the Replacement(s) may be different from the item originally ordered. In such cases, Merchant will make the necessary price adjustments. Merchant will notify you of any price adjustments before processing your order.

3.7 Conditions for Exchange or Replacement of Product

1. If a customer received a wrong product or, damaged product or, received a product that is not as described on the Platform, they may request an exchange or replacement of the product.
2. The customer must provide proof of purchase and a valid reason for the exchange or replacement request.
3. The vendor will be responsible for the cost of shipping the replacement or exchanged product to the customer.
4. The exchanged or replacement product must be of equal or lesser value than the original product purchased.
5. If the exchanged or replacement product is of lesser value than the original product purchased, the vendor must refund the difference to the customer.
6. If the exchanged or replacement product is of greater value than the original product purchased, the customer must pay the difference to the vendor.
7. The exchanged or replacement product must be in new, unused condition and in its original packaging.
8. The vendor has the right to refuse an exchange or replacement request if the product has been used or damaged by the customer.
9. The online QFREEMART platform is not responsible for any disputes or issues that arise between the customer and the vendor during the exchange or replacement process.
10. This policy is subject to change at any time without prior notice.

3.8 Non-returnable Products

Unless defective, damaged, expired, or incorrectly delivered, the following categories of products are generally not eligible for return, replacement, or exchange.

The following products are classified as non-returnable and cannot be returned, replaced, or exchanged:

- Products that are not covered under clause 4.1 of the refund policy;
- Products that are classified as hazardous materials or use flammable liquids or gases;

- Products that have been used or damaged by the customer, or are not in the same condition as when they were received;
- Products with tampered or missing serial numbers;
- Products that fall under specific categories, including but not limited to food, beverages, household goods, digital books, swimwear, hosiery, underwear, socks, health, contact lenses, hygiene-related and personal care products, certain baby products (such as tethers, diapers, hygiene tissues, and feeding-related products), music, video, and video games.

4. Refund or account credit Policy for Different Types of Products

4.1 Classification of items eligible for refunds:

We classify the products into several categories:

1. **Perishable Items:** These are products that have a limited shelf life and are likely to spoil or become unfit for use or consumption within a short period of time. Examples include dairy, meat, seafood, and baked goods.
2. **Fresh Product:** This category includes fresh fruits and vegetables that are harvested and sold in their natural state. These products are generally considered to have a longer shelf life than perishable items, but they can still spoil or deteriorate if not handled properly.
3. **Packaged Foods:** This category includes non-perishable items that are packaged and have a longer shelf life. Examples include canned goods, dry goods, and packaged snacks.
4. **Non-Perishable Items and Other Products:** This category includes items that are not intended for consumption. For such products exchange or replacement shall be the preferable methods of addressing complaints related to the items already purchased.

4.2 Refund Eligibility

We understand that sometimes products may not meet your expectations. Therefore, Customers may be eligible for refunds for products that are damaged, spoiled, defective, or incorrectly supplied, subject to the vendor's refund policies and applicable consumer protection laws. Refunds are not available for products that have been used or damaged by the customer.

4.3 Required Documentation

To process your refund request, we require photos of the product and order details as well as the return of the originally purchased item. This documentation helps us to verify the condition of the product and process your refund request quickly.

4.4 Process for Requesting a Refund

To request a refund, customers must follow the Vendor's refund process and contact the Vendor directly in accordance with the Vendor's policies. Customers may contact QFREEMART customer support only for assistance in facilitating communication between the customer and the Vendor. QFREEMART does not process, approve, track, or guarantee refunds issued by Vendors.

4.5 Timeframe for Processing and Issuing Refunds

The processing time for refunds depends on the vendor and the payment method used for the transaction. Vendors are responsible for informing customers of the expected refund processing timeframe and for completing the refund in accordance with their policies and applicable law.

5. Merchant Rights and Responsibilities

5.1 Providing Accurate Product Descriptions and Images

Merchants on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for providing accurate and detailed product descriptions and images. The product description should include all relevant information about the product, including its features, specifications, and any limitations or restrictions. The images should accurately represent the product and its condition.

5.2 Ensuring Proper Labelling, Packaging and Shipping of Items

Merchants on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for ensuring that all products are properly packaged and shipped to customers. This includes using appropriate packaging materials to protect the product during shipping and ensuring that the product is shipped in a timely manner.

5.3 Responding to Replace, Exchange, Refund Requests in a Timely Manner

Merchants on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for responding to refund requests in a timely manner. This includes acknowledging the refund request, reviewing the documentation provided by the customer, and processing the refund as quickly as possible.

5.4 Complying with the Platform's Refund Policy

Merchants on the QFREEMART platform are required to comply with the platform's refund policy. This includes following the guidelines and procedures outlined in the policy, processing refunds in a timely manner, and providing accurate and detailed information to customers. Merchants who fail to comply with the refund policy may be subject to penalties or other consequences as determined by the platform.

6. Customer Rights and Responsibilities

6.1 Reading and Understanding the Refund Policy

Customers on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for reading and understanding the refund policy. This includes reviewing the policy before making a purchase and familiarizing themselves with the conditions for refund eligibility, required documentation, and the process for requesting a refund.

6.2 Providing Accurate Shipping Information

Customers on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for providing accurate shipping information, including their name, address, and contact information. This information should be entered correctly at the time of purchase to ensure that the product is delivered to the correct address.

6.3 Inspecting Items Upon Receipt and Reporting Issues Promptly

Customers on the QFREEMART platform are responsible for inspecting the product upon receipt and reporting any issues promptly. This includes checking the product for damage, spoilage, or defects, and reporting any issues to the merchant or platform as soon as possible.

6.4 Providing Required Documentation for Refund Requests

Customers on the QFREEMART platform may be required to provide documentation to support their refund request, such as photos of the damaged or defective product, order details, and any other relevant information. Customers are responsible for providing all required documentation in a timely manner to ensure that their refund request can be processed as quickly as possible.

6.5 Consumer rights

Consumers are entitled to protections available under applicable consumer protection laws, including the Consumer Protection Act 2019 and related regulations. These rights may include the right to receive products that match their description, the right to fair grievance redressal, and the right to compensation where products are defective, damaged, or incorrectly supplied.

7. Dispute Resolution

7.1 Process for Resolving Disputes Between Merchants and Customers

In the event of a dispute between a merchant and a customer on the QFREEMART platform, the parties should first attempt to resolve the issue through direct communication. If the issue cannot be resolved through direct communication, the customer may file a dispute with the QFREEMART platform. The platform may review the dispute and facilitate communication between the customer and the vendor. However, QFREEMART does not process refunds and does not compel vendors to issue refunds.

7.2 Role of the Multi-Vendor Platform in Dispute Resolution

The QFREEMART platform plays a role in dispute resolution by providing a platform for communication between merchants and customers, and by providing a process for resolving disputes. The platform may also provide mediation or arbitration services to help resolve disputes between merchants and customers. QFREEMART may facilitate communication between vendors and customers to help resolve disputes. However, QFREEMART does not act as a judicial authority and does not guarantee enforcement of dispute outcomes between parties.

7.3 Platform Liability Limitation

QFREEMART shall not be responsible for refund decisions, refund processing delays, or refund disputes between vendors and customers. Any financial transactions and associated refund obligations remain solely between the vendor and the customer.

8. Policy Updates and Modifications

8.1 Notification of Policy Changes

The QFREEMART platform may update or modify the refund policy from time to time to reflect changes in the platform's policies or procedures, changes in applicable laws or regulations, or other factors. The platform will notify merchants and customers of any changes to the refund policy by posting the updated policy on the platform's website or by sending an email notification to registered users.

8.2 Effective Date of Policy Updates

The effective date of any updates or modifications to the refund policy will be clearly stated in the updated policy. The updated policy will apply to all purchases made on the platform after the effective date. Customers and merchants who continue to use the platform after the effective date of the updated policy are deemed to have accepted the updated policy and agree to comply with its terms and conditions.

Nothing in this Refund Policy limits any rights available under applicable consumer protection laws.

9. Contact Information

9.1 QFREEMART Customer Support Contact Details

Customers who have questions or concerns about the refund policy or need assistance with a refund request can contact the QFREEMART platform's customer support team. The customer support team can be reached by email, phone, or through the platform's messaging system. The contact details for the customer support team will be clearly stated on the platform's website.

9.2 Merchant Contact Details for Refund-Related Inquiries

Customers who need to contact a merchant regarding a refund request can find the merchant's contact details on the product page or in the order confirmation email. Merchants are required to provide accurate and up-to-date contact information to customers, including an email address and phone number. Customers should contact the merchant directly for any refund-related inquiries or issues.

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